

Example feedback for a participant from UBC

Personalized response options have been anonymized in this example.

Welcome to your individualized feedback

Thank you very much for participating in the entire PACE Study - we very much appreciate your dedicated participation!

Below, you find an **overview of the sections** of this feedback:

1. Study purpose
2. Interpreting your feedback
3. Frequency of situational variables (places, activities, in-person and online interactions)
4. Variation of stress and happiness across and within days
5. Happiness variation across situational variables
6. Data handling and how to learn about the study results

1. Study purpose

The PACE Study was specifically designed to investigate *dynamic* conceptualizations of personality traits, although we hope that the rich data collected will be used in various future research projects. Personality traits are commonly defined as stable tendencies to think, act, and feel a certain way across situations and time that allow differentiating between individuals (Baumert et al., 2017). Established approaches of personality traits assume that individuals have a single stable tendency (i.e., trait level) per personality characteristics (e.g., extraversion).

In contrast, dynamic approaches of personality assume that some people may have more than one typical trait level per personality characteristic (Danvers et al., 2020). For example, an individual might have a stable tendency to be introverted in specific situations and extraverted in others. In this research project, we aim to explore how these dynamic conceptualizations of personality can be measured and modeled statistically, and how contextual information can enrich our understanding of these patterns.

2. Interpreting your feedback

In the following sections, we will present feedback based on the responses you provided during the ESM (Experience Sampling Method) part of the study. It is important to keep in mind that this feedback does not necessarily represent an objective “ground truth” but rather reflects the patterns you reported. For example, during particularly happy moments, you may have chosen not to respond to the surveys in order to fully enjoy the moment. As a result, the feedback presented here may not fully capture these happiest moments, even though they are an essential part of your everyday life.

Additionally, none of the questions asked in this study were designed to assess clinical symptoms (e.g., depressive symptoms). Instead, we focused on variations in everyday, non-clinical experiences and behaviors. Therefore, the results cannot and should not be interpreted as a diagnosis of any psychological disorder. All reported results reflect normal variations in experiences and behaviors that are common among people.

Points to keep in mind:

- **Subjectivity of responses:** Your feedback is based on what you reported at the time. Personal circumstances or mood may have influenced when and how you responded.

- **Context of feedback:** The feedback reflects patterns observed during the study period but does not capture every aspect of your life. It is normal for experiences to fluctuate over time and across situations.
- **Limitations of ESM data:** The ESM method is a valuable tool for capturing real-time data, but it has its limitations. Your feedback should be seen as one piece of a larger picture of your experiences and behaviors.

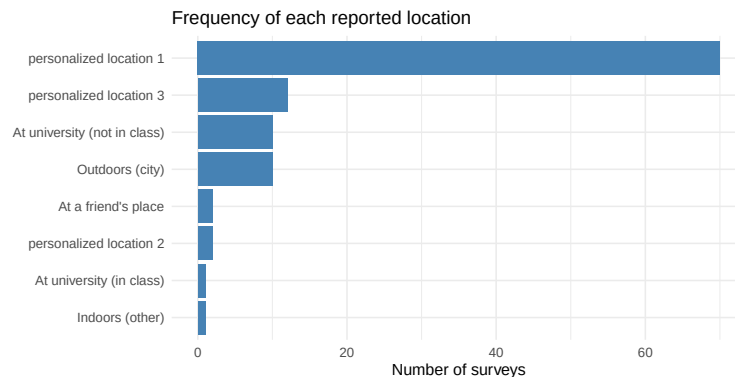
Frequency of situational variables

In the ESM surveys, we asked you to report details about your current situation, including where you were, what you were doing, and who you were with. In this section, we present the frequency statistics for these situational variables to give you an overview of the different contexts that make up your everyday life.

Locations

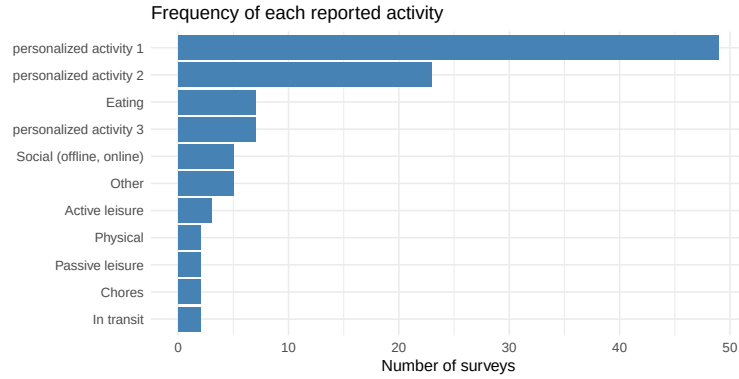
In the plot below, you can see how often you reported being in each location during the ESM part of the study. Only locations that you selected at least once are displayed. While the plot may suggest where you spent most of your time, it is imperfect in the sense that it only represents how often you reported being in each location but not how long you actually stayed there. In addition, it's important to remember that the results are based solely on the information you reported. For example, if you didn't receive or complete an ESM survey at certain times or places, those locations won't be reflected in the plot.

This means that while the plot shows your reported locations, it may not represent the full picture of your daily whereabouts. Keep this in mind when interpreting the results.



Activities

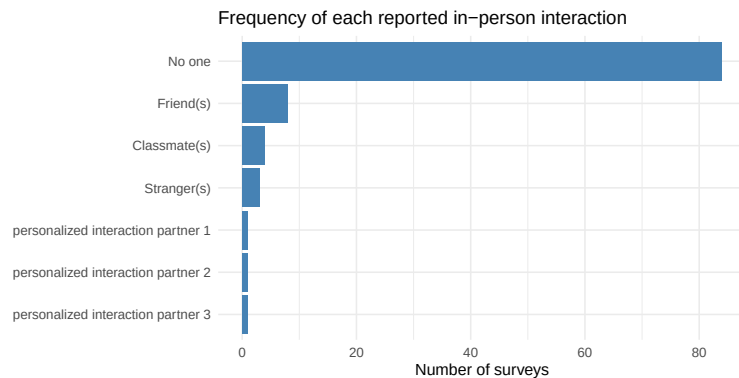
In the plot below, you can see how often you reported engaging in each activity during the ESM part of the study. It displays the number of surveys in which each activity was selected. Activities that you did not select at least once are not shown.



In-person interactions

The plot below shows how often you reported in-person interactions with each person or group of people. It displays the number of surveys in which each interaction was selected. Interactions that you did not select at least once are not shown.

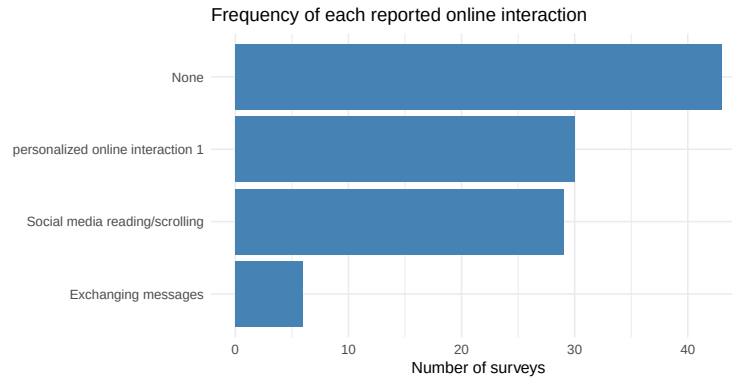
This plot provides an overview of the frequency of your reported in-person interactions in everyday life. It is important to note that this only reflects whether an interaction occurred, not how long the interaction lasted. Therefore, the results should not be interpreted as a measure of the time you spent with each person or group. Additionally, if a person or group is not displayed in this plot, this does not mean that they are not an essential part of your daily life.



Online interactions

The plot below shows how often you reported engaging in various types of online interactions. Only interactions that you reported at least once are displayed.

This plot offers a glimpse into the online interactions that may be most frequent in your daily life. It's important to note that the results only indicate whether an interaction occurred, not its duration or intensity. Therefore, interactions that do not appear in the plot may still play a significant role in your everyday life, and any interactions that were reported frequently may have been relatively brief.



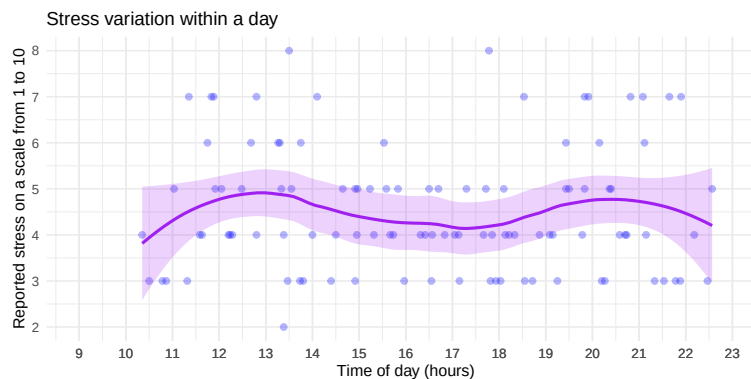
4. Variation of stress and happiness across and within days

In this section, we will describe how your self-reported level of stress and happiness varied across and within days. This information may inform you about whether there are certain times during the day or days within a week where you feel particularly stressed or happy.

Stress variation within a day

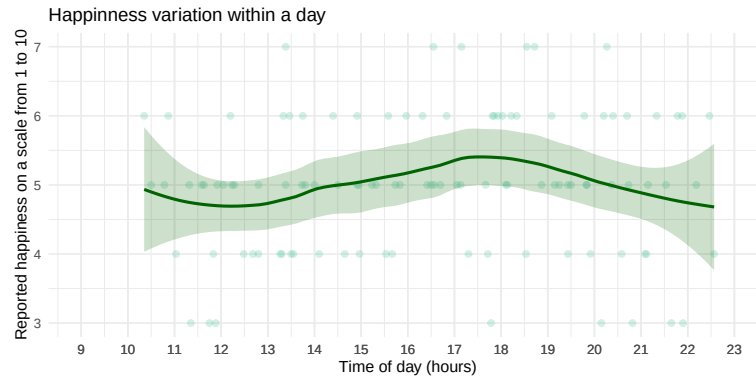
The plot below shows how your reported stress levels changed throughout the day. It provides information about the average patterns of your stress level and how consistently you reported certain stress levels at different times throughout the day.

- **Purple line:** This line represents the average stress level you reported at each time of the day, giving a general pattern of how your stress levels changed over the course of the day.
- **Shaded purple area:** The shaded area shows the range where your average stress level is likely to fall at each time of day. It reflects how much your stress levels varied at similar times and how many data points were collected. A wide shaded area might mean that your reported stress levels varied a lot at that time of day, or that fewer surveys were completed at that time.
- **Dots:** Each dot represents the stress level you reported in a particular ESM survey on a scale from 1 (not at all stressed) to 10 (extremely stressed). These dots help you see whether the width of the shaded area at a given time of the day is mainly driven by the range of reported stress levels at that time or by the number of completed surveys.



Happiness variation within a day

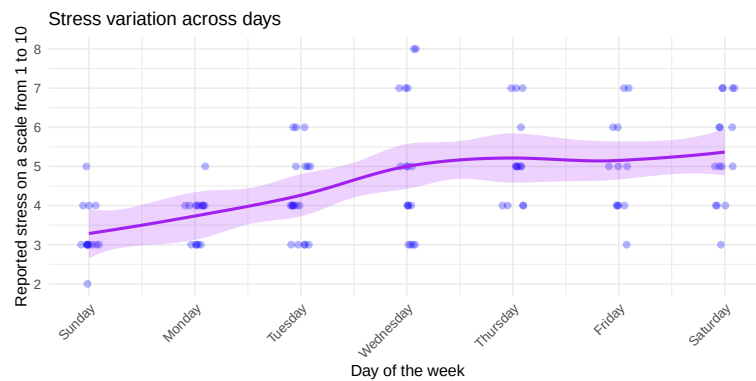
The plot below shows how your reported happiness levels changed throughout the day, using the same format as in the previous plot displaying stress variation within a day. The plot elements (line, shaded area, and dots) are interpreted in the same way and you can refer to the description of the stress plot if you need a reminder about how to interpret these elements.



Stress variation across days

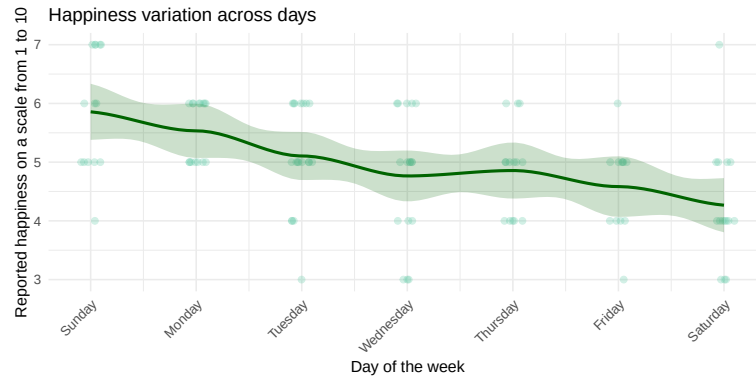
Next, we sorted all your stress levels according to the day of the week when you reported them. This plot provides information about the average patterns of your stress levels across days and how consistently you reported certain stress levels on specific days.

- **Purple line:** This line represents the average stress level you reported for each day of the week. The shape of the line shows whether there tends to be a change in your average stress level over the course of the week.
- **Shaded purple area:** The shaded area shows the range where your average stress level is likely to fall at day. It reflects the variability of both your responses and the amount of data collected for each day. A wider shaded area means that your stress levels varied more on a given day, or that there were fewer data points collected.
- **Dots:** Each dot represents the stress level you reported in a particular ESM survey on a scale from 1 (not at all stressed) to 10 (extremely stressed). The dots are spread out horizontally (using a technique called "jitter") to help avoid overlap and make it easier to see individual responses. This spread does not reflect differences in days; it's just to ensure that all dots can be seen.



Happiness variation across days

The plot below shows how your reported happiness levels changed across days of the week, using the same format as in the previous plot of stress variation within a week. The plot elements (line, shaded area, and dots) are interpreted in the same way, and you can refer to the description of the stress plot if you need a reminder about how to interpret these elements.



5. Happiness variation across situational variables

Lastly, we present how your reported happiness varied depending on different situational variables, including where you were, what you were doing, and who you were with. While these variables *might* help explain some of the short-term variations in your happiness, there are many other factors that could also be responsible. These include biological factors (e.g., sleep quality), everyday events (e.g., receiving a good grade or having an argument), and major life events (e.g., starting or ending a romantic relationship), among others.

Happiness variation across locations

The plot below shows how your reported happiness levels varied across different locations you were in. It provides information on how much happier or less happy you tended to be at each location compared to your overall average level of happiness. To ensure the reliability of the results, we only included locations with at least five completed ESM surveys.

- **Vertical green line:** This line represents your average level of happiness across all locations. It serves as a reference point to help you see how each location's happiness average compares to your overall average.
- **Black dots:** Each black dot represents the average level of happiness you reported at a specific location. The distance between these black dots represents how strongly your happiness tends to differ between locations on average.
- **Shaded green rectangles:** These shaded areas around each black dot represent the variability in your reported happiness at each location. A wider shaded area indicates more variation in your reported happiness at that location. If the shaded areas of different locations overlap substantially, this suggests that your happiness variability within each location is larger than the differences between locations. This could mean that other factors than where you are may play a larger role in influencing your happiness.
- **Green dots:** Each green dot represents an individual happiness rating that you reported during an ESM survey. These dots are slightly spread out horizontally (using a technique called "jitter") to avoid overlap, making it easier to see all individual data points.

Important note: These results do **not** necessarily mean that being in certain locations caused changes in your happiness. For example, the plot might show that your happiness levels were higher at home than in other places, but this doesn't mean that being at home was the reason you felt happier. Many other factors may also, or perhaps more strongly, have impacted your happiness than your location. Additionally, it's possible that your current mood led you to choose certain locations (e.g., seeking out a comforting place like home when feeling down), which would suggest the opposite direction of influence.



Happiness variation across activities

The plot below shows how your reported happiness levels varied across different activities that you reported doing at least five times in an ESM survey. It provides an overview of which activities were associated with higher or lower levels of happiness on average. The vertical green line represents your overall average happiness across all activities, serving as a reference point. The black dots indicate the average happiness for each activity, while the shaded rectangles represent the range of variability in your happiness during those activities. Remember, this plot only reflects the reported associations between activities and mood and does not necessarily indicate that specific activities caused changes in your happiness.



Happiness variation across in-person interactions

The plot below shows how your reported happiness levels varied across different in-person interactions that you reported at least five times in an ESM survey. It provides an overview of which in-person interactions were associated with higher or lower levels of happiness on average. The vertical green line represents your overall average happiness across all in-person interactions, serving as a reference point. The black dots indicate the average happiness for each kind of in-person interaction, while the shaded rectangles represent the range of variability in your happiness during those various interactions. Remember, this plot only reflects

the reported associations between in-person interactions and mood and does not necessarily indicate that specific in-person interactions caused changes in your happiness.



Happiness variation across online interactions

The plot below shows how your reported happiness levels varied across different online interactions that you reported at least five times in an ESM survey. It provides an overview of which online interactions were associated with higher or lower levels of happiness on average. The vertical green line represents your overall average happiness across all online interactions, serving as a reference point. The black dots indicate the average happiness for each kind of online interaction, while the shaded rectangles represent the range of variability in your happiness during those various interactions. Remember, this plot only reflects the reported associations between online interactions and mood and does not necessarily indicate that specific online interactions caused changes in your happiness.



6. Data handling and how to learn about the study results

Data will be stored at the University of British Columbia on an encrypted, password-protected computer, and will be stored for a minimum of 5 years. The data you provide may be subsequently reported in academic writing. However, such reports will only include group-level analyses and your data cannot and will not be personally identified in any reports of the completed study. Please note that we cannot withdraw your data after the study period has ended, as any identifying information stored on the survey platform formr during data collection will be deleted at that time.

At the end of the project, anonymized data may be archived and shared with others for legitimate research purposes. In keeping with recommended best practices in psychological research, this includes the possibility that funders or publication outlets may require the data from this study to be "Open Access". In that case,

your anonymous answers will be merged with the answers of the other participants in a large database. This database will then be posted in an established open repository, such as the Open Science Framework (osf.io), where it will be securely stored on platform-owned servers and accessible to other researchers.

To ask for a general summary of the findings once the study has been completed and results have been obtained, please contact Anabel Büchner who leads the study as part of her dissertation. Alternatively, you may contact the principal investigator Dr. Friedrich Götz.

If you have any questions regarding this feedback, you can simply reply to this email.

Best,

Your PACE Study Team